High-level design

Implemented architecture: 2026-10-20. The nine functional requirements are covered by
API and PostgreSQL tests. Reviewer-startup and final delivery checks are tracked in the
execution log rather than inferred from this design.

Requirements and scope

A single airline's back office creates immutable schedules. Customers search by airports/date, inspect aircraft seat maps, book selected seats and cancel a booking.
Airports and aircraft are seeded, not managed through APIs. Bookings cover one flight.
The window contains 365 UTC dates starting today.

The clarified envelope is 10k DAU, 500 schedules, 25:1 search/booking traffic, a one-second search target, and strongly consistent booking. Search may become stale if
the booking API explains a seat conflict. DAU alone does not establish a QPS estimate.

Out of scope: payments/refunds, pricing, notifications, user accounts, timezone conversion, seat holds, partial cancellation, connecting flights, search sort/filter
controls and additional listing/retrieval APIs.

Overall architecture and components

```mermaid
flowchart LR
    Admin[Trusted back office] --> API[Spring MVC API]
    Customer[Customer] --> API
    API --> Schedule[Schedule service]
    API --> Flight[FlightService]
    API --> Booking[BookingService]
    API --> Cancel[CancellationService]
    Booking --> Materializer[FlightInstanceService]
    Booking --> Writer[BookingTransactionService]
    Schedule --> Repositories[Flat Spring Data JPA repositories]
    Flight --> Repositories
    Materializer --> Repositories
    Writer --> Repositories
    Cancel --> Repositories
    Repositories --> Pools[Read 5 / write 10 connection routing]
    Pools --> DB[(PostgreSQL)]
    Flyway[Flyway migrations] --> DB
```

One Java 21 / Spring Boot deployable; PostgreSQL is its only external dependency.
The Java root uses conventional controller/service/repository/entity packages, separate
DTO request/response packages, `service.impl`, immutable application `model` records,
and configuration/exception/validation packages.
Packages are organized by layer, not by business feature.
MVC handles transport; services define business rules and transactions; Spring Data JPA
repositories handle persistence. Narrow service interfaces exchange application models,

not JPA entities or API DTOs. Controllers map transport records and implementations
map persistence objects internally. `repository/` contains flat Spring Data interfaces,
not pass-through adapters. This deliberately favors conventional layered Spring design
over a strictly persistence-independent core. Entities never become API response bodies.
Lombok supplies component constructors/logging and
entity getters. Explicit local types are used instead of `var`.

The same artifact may run behind a load balancer as multiple stateless instances.
The delivered Compose setup defaults to one application and one database. There are
no JVM-local seat locks, sessions, mutable seat caches, broker or leader-election jobs.
Admin authentication belongs to a trusted external boundary; this backend does not
implement it or pretend that an `/admin` URL authenticates callers.

Service interactions and request flows

Flow	Interaction and failure boundary
Create schedule	Controller -> schedule service -> reference checks -> schedule and day inserts in one transaction. Any failure rolls both back.
Search	Controller -> flight query -> one route/day aggregate including active allocation count. No writes.
Seat map	Resolve operating schedule/date -> read active labels -> derive complete configured map. Missing instance means fully available.
Book	Coordinator validates -> short materialization transaction commits -> booking transaction inserts booking and sorted allocations -> commit or full rollback. Known seat conflicts are reported after rollback.
Cancel	Lookup with instance/schedule -> check UTC departure/status -> read assigned labels -> conditional booking status update -> release all seats in one transaction. Release-count mismatch rolls everything back.

All interactions are synchronous and in-process except database access. Separate
transactional beans make proxy boundaries explicit. Materialization is not nested in
the booking transaction and never needs a second simultaneous connection. The booking
coordinator rejects ambient transactions with `Propagation.NEVER` before persistence.
JSON negotiation occurs before controller invocation; strict HH:mm parsing prevents
invalid 24:00 clocks being normalized into midnight.

Flight generation strategy

Hybrid generation projects bookable flights from immutable schedules and the requested
date. Reads do not enumerate a year or materialize missing rows. First booking creates
one instance with `UNIQUE(schedule_id, flight_date)`; later bookings reuse it.

Full materialization is allowed by the assignment and manageable at this scale, but
requires maintaining a rolling horizon. Dynamic-only storage is possible but complicates
allocation references. Hybrid keeps the rolling window a predicate while giving

bookings
a stable foreign-key target.

Concurrency strategy

The authoritative active-seat invariant is:

```sql
CREATE UNIQUE INDEX uq_booking_seat_active
    ON booking_seat (flight_instance_id, seat_label)
    WHERE status = 'BOOKED';
```

Canonical seat validation prevents alternate labels identifying the same seat.
Multi-seat inserts follow one deterministic order to reduce deadlock risk. Uniqu
eness
and atomic transactions prevent overselling across any number of application ins
tances.
A seat conflict aborts the whole booking and returns 409; it is not retried as a
 transient
failure. READ COMMITTED is sufficient for this schema-enforced invariant.

Pessimistic/optimistic inventory locking are valid alternatives, but would add l
ockable
inventory rows or serialize unrelated seats through the parent flight. No availa
bility
counter, `@Version`, distributed lock or reservation state is needed here.

Cancellation changes booking and allocation state atomically. Released historica
l rows
leave the partial index and allow reuse. A concurrent booker can succeed after r
elease
commits or encounter the still-active owner; neither may produce partial allocat
ion.

Major design decisions and assumptions

See [the decision log](../features/ATS-1/decision-log.md) for alternatives.

- One immutable schedule per flight number is an explicit identity assumption.
- UTC schedule time plus UTC flight date defines departure. No airport-local inf
erence.
- `[today, today + 365)` contains exactly 365 dates, including across leap years
.
- Arrival time may precede departure time; the API does not compute duration/arr
ival date.
- Booking uses UUID references; passenger count is derived from seat allocations
.
- The user selected 409 on repeat cancellation and on cancellation after departu
re.
- Spring Data JPA supplies repository operations and a JPQL search projection. T
he
  instance upsert is native SQL; database constraints remain authoritative. Flyw
ay owns
  schema evolution; Hibernate validates it and OSIV is disabled.
- POST booking is not idempotent: a lost response can leave the caller without i
ts
  reference. No extra recovery/idempotency API is claimed to exist.

Operational limits and scale considerations

Pool acquisition timeout is not an end-to-end search deadline. Measure full HTTP

 latency
with 500 schedules and documented data/load. Query-count regressions and EXPLAIN
 help
diagnose performance; small-table sequential scans are legitimate.

Spring's `LazyConnectionDataSourceProxy` routes read-only search/maps to a dedic
ated
five-connection pool on the same primary: 250 ms acquisition, 500 ms PostgreSQL
statement
timeout and 250 ms lock timeout. Ordinary transactions retain a separate ten-con
nection
pool and 20 s acquisition. Booking lookup/conflict enrichment use write capacity
;
lookup within a read-only seat-map transaction joins that read transaction. Satu
rated
reads return explicit 503 rather than starving booking connections. Physical-poo
l
exhaustion and SQL/lock cancellation/recovery are exercised by `ReadIsolationIT`
.
The combined maximum is 15 per replica, 45 for three against the local 100 limit
.
Database budgets do not bound HTTP queueing, network or cold connection establis
hment.

Total replica pool demand must fit PostgreSQL's connection budget. A pooler, rep
licas,
cache or queue is a future option only when measurements justify it, not impleme
nted
infrastructure. Live availability is snapshot-consistent, not a seat hold.
Readiness includes database connectivity, while liveness does not depend on the
database.

Search projects four fields in one SQL statement without hydrating entities. An
explicit
entity graph fetches the aircraft needed for flight resolution; a seat map then
reads
active labels, with no per-seat query loop. IDENTITY-based seat saves execute in
dividual
inserts in deterministic label order; `saveAllAndFlush` is not asserted to be ba
tching.
Booking latency may vary under contention as allowed by the clarified requiremen
ts.

Evidence and deployment boundaries

`CrossInstanceIT` runs two independent Spring web contexts, connection pools and
 HTTP
ports against one PostgreSQL primary. Concurrent same-seat POSTs produce one 201
 and
one 409; either context can cancel and rebook the committed allocation. These ar
e
independent contexts in one JVM, not a claim of a multi-host deployment benchmar
k.
Compose additionally permits separate JVM replicas using a host-port range. An
isolated three-container acceptance run produced one 201 and two 409s for the sa
me
seat, followed by successful cancellation and rebooking through different JVMs.

The same test stops the database: liveness remains 200, readiness becomes 503 an
d
booking returns an explicit 503 with an unconfirmed-outcome warning. Health deta
ils

are not exposed to unauthenticated callers. Correlation identifiers are validated,
echoed and cleared from MDC after requests; passenger names and payloads are not logged.

Search was measured through real HTTP with 500 schedules and 600,000 synthetic active/historical allocations: the post-review eight-worker p95 was 7.332 ms. The separate 25:1 mixed run at 16/64/192 clients measured search p95 15.049/34.228/97.745 ms. All 816 disjoint bookings succeeded; the 192-client phase shed one of 14,400 searches with 503. No measured search response exceeded one second. These phases lasted 0.879/2.268/6.120 seconds, not a sustained capacity certification. See [LLD](../lld/design.md#query-audit-and-measured-performance) for dataset, actual SQL plan and limitations. No lazy-loading API is presently necessary; if scale changes, bounded pagination/lazy loading is a measured follow-up, not an existing endpoint or unlimited-throughput claim.

The backend contains no authentication. Deployment must restrict the administrative route at a trusted gateway; UUID references are identifiers, not an authorization system. Payments and other excluded integrations are not called, so no fabricated black-box client or static payment step is inserted into a booking.